

# The Enchanted Adventure of Max and Friends

Little adventurers • 3-4 years old



## The Mysterious Map

Once upon a time, in a cozy little town, there lived a brave young boy named Max. Max was four years old and loved adventures. He had curly brown hair and always wore his favorite red hat. One sunny morning, Max found something very special in his backyard.

« **Look, Charlie!** » Max called to his best friend.

Charlie, who was also four, ran over. He had big glasses and loved to read books. « **What is it, Max?** » Charlie asked, eyes wide with curiosity.

« **It's a map!** » Max said, holding up an old, crinkly paper. The map was covered in colorful drawings and mysterious symbols.

« **Ooooh,** » said Charlie. « **What do you think it leads to?** »

Max thought for a moment. « **Maybe it's treasure! Or a secret place!** »

Just then, their friend Lily joined them. Lily had shiny black hair and a big, friendly smile. « **What are you two looking at?** » she asked.

Max showed her the map. « **We're going on an adventure!** » he declared.

Lily clapped her hands. « **I love adventures! Can I come too?** »

« **Of course!** » said Max. « **The more the merrier!** »

And so, the three friends set off on their adventure, the map leading the way.

## The Secret Path

The map led the children through their neighborhood, past the big oak tree and Mrs. Green's flower garden. They followed the dotted line until they reached a tall, wooden fence.

« **Look!** » said Charlie, pointing. « **There's a tiny door!** »

Indeed, there was a small, hidden door in the fence, just big enough for them to crawl through. Max opened the door, and they all squeezed through it.

On the other side, they found a secret path lined with colorful flowers and sparkling stones. The sun shone brightly, and birds chirped happily in the trees.

« **This is amazing!** » Lily exclaimed, twirling around in excitement.

As they walked down the path, they saw a little pond with clear, blue water. In the middle of the pond was a small island with a big, old tree.

« **The map says the treasure is on the island!** » Max said, pointing to the drawing.

« **But how do we get there?** » Charlie wondered.

Lily spotted a little rowboat tied to a post. « **We can use that boat!** » she exclaimed.

Carefully, the friends climbed into the boat. Max held the oars, and with some teamwork, they paddled across the pond to the island.

## The Secret Treasure

On the island, the big tree stood tall and proud. Its leaves rustled gently in the breeze. Max looked at the map again.



« **X marks the spot,** » he said, pointing to a spot near the tree.

They all started digging in the soft earth with their hands. Before long, they found a small, wooden box buried in the ground.

« **This must be it!** » said Max, brushing off the dirt.

Charlie opened the box carefully. Inside, they found shiny marbles, colorful seashells, and a little book of stories.

« **It's a treasure of wonders!** » Lily said, her eyes sparkling with delight.

The friends sat down under the tree and admired their discovery. They each took a marble and a shell to remember their adventure.

« **This was the best adventure ever,** » said Max, smiling.

« **And we did it together,** » added Charlie.

Lily nodded. « **We make a great team!** »

As the sun began to set, the friends knew it was time to go home. They paddled back across the pond, went through the tiny door, and retraced their steps back to Max's backyard.

« **Thank you for the adventure, Max,** » said Charlie.

« **Yes, thank you!** » said Lily. « **I can't wait for our next one!** »

Max grinned. « **There are always more adventures waiting. We just have to find them!** »

And with that, the three friends promised to always explore, imagine, and discover the wonders of their little town together. As they waved goodbye and headed home, they knew that their friendship was the greatest treasure of all.

## The quiz: did you understand the story well?

### 1) What did Max find in his backyard?

- A toy
- A map
- A book
- A bird

### 2) Who helped Max on his adventure?

- Charlie and Lily
- His mom
- A dog
- A stranger

### 3) What was in the treasure box?

- A snack
- Shiny marbles and shells
- A toy car
- A hat

### 4) What did the friends do at the big tree?

- They danced
- They dug in the ground
- They sang songs
- They took a nap

#### Correct answers:

1) A map 2) Charlie and Lily 3) Shiny marbles and shells 4) They dug in the ground

## Glossary: complicated words in the story

**Mysterious:** Something that is strange or difficult to understand; it makes you wonder what it is.

**Adventure:** An exciting journey or experience where you discover new things.

**Treasure:** Valuable things, like gold, jewels, or special items, that are hidden or kept safe.

**Symbols:** Pictures or marks that represent something else, often used to help understand instructions.

**Island:** A piece of land that is completely surrounded by water.

**Curiosity:** A strong desire to learn or know more about something.